



Fractions

A FRACTION REPRESENTS A PART OF A WHOLE NUMBER.
THEY ARE WRITTEN AS ONE NUMBER OVER ANOTHER NUMBER.

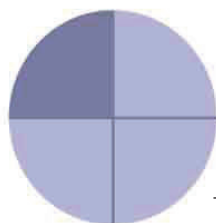
Writing fractions

The number on the top of a fraction shows how many equal parts of the whole are being dealt with, while the number on the bottom shows the total number of equal parts that the whole has been divided into.

1 — **Numerator**
The number of equal parts examined.

— **Dividing line**
This is also written as $\div$.

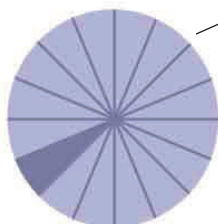
2 — **Denominator**
Total number of equal parts in the whole.



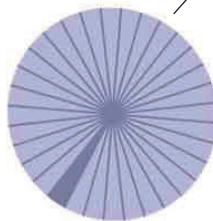
Quarter
One fourth, or $\frac{1}{4}$ (a quarter), shows 1 part out of 4 equal parts in a whole.



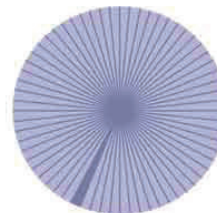
Eighth
 $\frac{1}{8}$ (one eighth) is 1 part out of 8 equal parts in a whole.



Sixteenth
 $\frac{1}{16}$ (one sixteenth) is 1 part out of 16 equal parts in a whole.



One thirty-second
 $\frac{1}{32}$ (one thirty-second) is 1 part out of 32 equal parts in a whole.



One sixty-fourth
 $\frac{1}{64}$ (one sixty-fourth) is 1 part out of 64 equal parts in a whole.

▷ Equal parts of a whole

The circle on the right shows how parts of a whole can be divided in different ways to form different fractions.

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◀ 22–25 Division

◀ 44–45 Decimals

Ratio and proportion **56–59** ▶

Percentages **60–61** ▶

Converting fractions, decimals, and percentages **64–65** ▶

